1 **INTERVIEW SKILLS FOR EMPLOYMENT SUCCESS**

Mastering key techniques to secure your dream job

2 **WARM-UP ACTIVITY: SELL AN OBJECT**

Choose an object in the classroom and work individually or a group to:

- Brainstorm creative or unconventional ways the object could be used.
- Identify unique features or selling points that make it appealing.
- Prepare a quick pitch to share your ideas with the class.

3 **UNDERSTANDING INTERVIEWS**

4 **WHAT IS AN INTERVIEW?**

Definition and Purpose

An interview is a structured conversation to assess mutual fit, skills, and readiness for a job role.

Employer Perspective

Employers evaluate if candidates align with company culture and job requirements during interviews.

Candidate Perspective

Candidates showcase qualifications and assess if the organization fits their career goals.

Interview Formats

Interviews can be conducted in-person, by phone, video, or in panel formats.

5 **INTERVIEWING IS A SKILL**

Practice Enhances Skill

Interviewing skills improve with practice through mock interviews and self-reflection, increasing confidence and effectiveness.

Preparation Reduces Anxiety

Proper preparation helps reduce natural nervousness and anxiety associated with high-stakes interviews.

Learning from Feedback

Using feedback rubrics and peer reviews allows candidates to refine their approach and understand expectations.

Simulating Real Scenarios

Simulated interview environments help build competence and readiness for actual job interviews.

6 **THE INTERVIEW PROCESS**

Preparation Phase

Research the employer, review the job description, and practice your responses before the interview.

Beginning of Interview

Start the interview with greetings and introductions to set a positive tone.

Core Interview Discussion

Engage in the main conversation where questions are asked and detailed answers are provided.

Closing and Follow-Up

Conclude with final questions, express interest, and send a thank-you note after the interview.

7 ☐ **PREPARING FOR INTERVIEWS**

8 ☐ **PREPARATION TIPS**

Researching the Employer

Understanding the employer’s mission, culture, and news shows genuine interest in the role.

Reviewing Job Description

Careful review of job requirements helps candidates align their skills accordingly.

Practicing Interview Questions

Practicing common questions improves confidence and communication during the interview.

Professional Attire and Punctuality

Planning appropriate clothing and arriving early demonstrate professionalism and respect.

9 ☐ **RESEARCHING THE EMPLOYER**

Understand Company Overview

Learn about the company's purpose, goals, products, and services to build a solid knowledge base.

Learn About Company Culture

Familiarize yourself with the organization's culture to align responses during the interview.

Prepare for Job Role and Interviewers

Research the specific job role and interviewers to tailor answers and ask relevant questions.

Demonstrate Initiative

Showing genuine interest through research reflects enthusiasm and impresses potential employers.

10 ☐ **PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATION**

11 ☐ **DRESS FOR SUCCESS**

Professionalism Through Attire

Appropriate dressing shows professionalism and respect for the interview opportunity, boosting candidate confidence.

Align with Company Culture

Choosing attire that matches the company culture helps candidates fit in and show understanding of expectations.

Neat Grooming and Minimal Accessories

Clean grooming and minimal accessories contribute to a polished and serious interview appearance.

Use Dress Checklist

Reviewing dress checklists and industry expectations helps candidates make informed outfit choices for interviews.

12 ☐ **DRESS FOR SUCCESS VIDEO**

13 ☐ **BODY LANGUAGE MATTERS**

14 ☐ **BODY LANGUAGE TIPS**

15 ☐ **BASIC INTERVIEW TIPS**

Timeliness and Politeness

Arriving early and being polite to everyone helps establish a positive and respectful atmosphere.

Confident Introduction

Introducing yourself confidently with a firm handshake sets a professional tone for the interview.

Preparedness
Bringing copies of your resume demonstrates preparation and professionalism.
Assertive Body Language
Maintaining eye contact and expressing enthusiasm conveys confidence and interest in the position.

16 ☐ **INTERVIEW TECHNIQUES**

17 ☐ **ANSWERING QUESTIONS: STAR METHOD**

Structured Interview Approach

- *Situation or Task*

Describe the situation that you were in or the task that you needed to accomplish. You must describe a specific event or situation, not a generalized description of what you have done in the past. Be sure to give enough detail for the interviewer to understand. This situation can be from a previous job, from a volunteer experience, or any relevant event, but try to steer clear of personal situations that give away too many personal details.

- *Action you took*

Describe the action you took and be sure to keep the focus on you. Even if you are discussing a group project or effort, describe what you did -- not the efforts of the team. Don't tell what you might do. Tell what you did.

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- *Results you achieved*

What happened? How did the event end? What did you accomplish? What did you learn?

Why use it?
It helps you give clear, focused answers that show problem-solving, decision-making, and impact.

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18 ☐ **EXAMPLE OF AN EXCELLENT ANSWER**

19 ☐ **EXAMPLE OF AN EXCELLENT ANSWER**

20 ☐ **PRESENTATION ACTIVITY: STAR METHOD PRACTICE**

- Use the STAR method to answer the questions on the “Shine Bright with STAR Interviews!”
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21 ☐ **QUESTIONS TO ASK EMPLOYERS**

Demonstrate Interest
Asking thoughtful questions shows genuine interest and preparation for the role and company.
Examples of Questions
Effective questions include role success, team culture, and hiring process steps.
Tailor to Role

Questions should be researched and customized based on the specific job and organization.

22 ☐ **SAMPLE QUESTIONS TO ASK**

- WILL YOU DESCRIBE THE CHARACTERISTICS OF THE PERSON BEST SUITED FOR THIS JOB?
- WHAT ADVANCEMENT OPPORTUNITIES ARE AVAILABLE WITH YOUR COMPANY?
- WHAT TYPE OF PEOPLE TEND TO DO WELL IN THIS POSITION AND WHO DO NOT?
- ARE THERE RESERVATIONS YOU HAVE ABOUT MY FIT FOR THE POSITION THAT I COULD TRY TO ADDRESS?

A MUST ASK QUESTION

- WHEN WILL YOU BE MAKING A DECISION AND HOW WILL I BE NOTIFIED?

23 ☐ **DURING AND ENDING THE INTERVIEW**

Effective Interview Behavior

Maintaining good posture and positivity enhances a candidate's presence and confidence during the interview.

Organized Communication

Organizing thoughts before responding and referring to resume helps deliver clear and relevant answers.

Closing the Interview

Asking prepared questions, thanking the interviewer, smiling, and shaking hands create a strong positive impression.

24 ☐ **PRACTICE AND FOLLOW-UP**

25 ☐ **MOCK INTERVIEW PRACTICE**

Why do Mock Interviews help?

Building Confidence and Skills

Mock interviews help candidates build confidence and refine communication skills through practice.

Focused Practice Areas

Candidates focus on tone, clarity, and body language to improve overall interview performance.

Effective Peer Feedback

Peer feedback includes two positives and one suggestion to promote constructive learning.

Simulating Real Interviews

Simulated real interview settings help identify improvement areas and prepare candidates effectively.

26 ☐ **CHATGPT INTERVIEW PRACTICE**

- Step 1: Choose a job you are interested in applying for.
- Step 2: Open ChatGPT.
- Step 3: Copy and paste the prompt below into ChatGPT.
- You are an employer conducting a professional job interview. I am applying for an entry-level position that matches my skills and experience. Please conduct a mock job interview with me. Ask me one interview question at a time and wait for my response before asking the next question. Include common interview questions such as: Work experience, Strengths and skills, Problem-solving, Teamwork, Reliability and professionalism. After the interview is finished, provide clear and constructive feedback on my answers. Tell me: What I did well What I can improve? How I can

make my answers stronger for a real interview? Keep the tone professional, supportive, and encouraging.

- Step 4: Answer the interview questions as if this were a real interview.
- Step 5: When finished, ask ChatGPT for feedback on your answers.
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27 ☐ **FOLLOW-UP ETIQUETTE**

Timely Thank-You Note

Send a personalized thank-you note within 24 hours to express gratitude and reinforce interest.

Reflect on Interview

Review the interview to identify strengths and areas for improvement for future opportunities.

Polite Follow-Up Call

If no response, make a courteous follow-up call after one week to inquire about the decision.

28 ☐ **FINAL THOUGHTS**

Growth Through Interviews

Interviews offer valuable opportunities for personal growth and effective self-presentation.

Preparation Builds Confidence

Thorough preparation and consistent practice significantly boost confidence and competence.

Positive and Persistent Mindset

Maintaining positivity, persistence, and openness to learning enhances interview success.

Interviews as Developable Skills

Viewing interviews as skills to develop empowers candidates to engage with enthusiasm.